

PRACTICE QUICK SHEET

Tuesday, Sept. 8 | 6:30–8:00 PM | Davis Park Field 1

TODAY'S FOCUS

Situational Defense • Cutoffs • Defensive Responsibilities • Baseball IQ

Key message: EVERY player has a job when the ball is hit.

6:30–6:40 | WARM-UP + THROWING

- Dynamic warm-up
 - Partner throwing
 - Finish with quick catch → transfer → throw
 - Emphasize **quick, accurate throws — don't hold the ball**
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6:40–7:05 | 3 STATIONS

~8 min each — rotate groups

1 — OUTFIELD: GET IT IN

 LF / LCF

Attack → Field → Turn → Throw

- Attack the baseball
- Quick transfer
- Find the cutoff
- Throw through the cutoff
- **NO holding the baseball**
- Competition: Ball hit → cutoff catch time

2 — FORCE vs. TAG

 1B foul territory — cone mini-diamond

Run different runner situations.

- Runner forced to advance → **BASE**
- Runner not forced → **TAG**
- Players rotate defender/runner
- Ask before each rep: "**Force or tag?**"

3 — INFIELD DECISIONS

📌 **3B / SS side**

Call situation BEFORE each ground ball.

- Nobody on → **1B**
- Runner on 1st → **2B**
- Runner on 2nd → **Check runner / 1B**
- Runners 1st & 2nd → **Easiest force**
- 2 outs → **Easiest out**

Decision first. Execution second.

7:05–7:30 | FULL-TEAM DEFENSE

📌 **Entire field — NO other stations**

Hit balls around the field and teach positioning.

OF / MIDDLE-INFIELD RULE

Ball to LEFT → SS goes out for cutoff / 2B covers second

Ball to RIGHT → 2B goes out for cutoff / SS covers second

Outfielders:

FIELD IT → FIND CUTOFF → GET RID OF IT

PITCHER

Don't watch the play — BACK IT UP.

Teach pitcher to move behind the appropriate base/throw.

COACHING METHOD

Use **FREEZE** → **CORRECT** → **REPLAY**

Stop the play when positioning is wrong, physically move players where they belong, then replay the same situation.

7:30–7:55 | CONTROLLED LIVE GAME

Coach Pitch — 40 ft

Announce situation **BEFORE EVERY BATTER:**

"Runner on first — one out!"

Then play it LIVE.

Defense must identify:

1. Where is the force?
2. Where is the play?
3. Who covers the base?
4. Who is the cutoff?
5. Who backs up the throw?

Freeze and replay mistakes.

Hitting is secondary today — **defensive execution is the objective.**

7:55–8:00 | FLAME BALL CHALLENGE

COACHING VOCABULARY

Keep our terminology consistent:

"KNOW THE PLAY!" — Think before the pitch.

"GET IT IN!" — OF gets rid of the baseball.

"HIT THE CUTOFF!" — No hero throws.

"COVER OR CUT!" — SS/2B know their responsibilities.

"FORCE OR TAG?" — Know how the out is made.

"BACK IT UP!" — Don't spectate.

EVERY PLAYER HAS A JOB.

RESPECT • EFFORT • NO WALKING